a jesting parody of Khwāja Ḥāfiẓ,—"Ah! the happy, thoughtless time when, with our names in ill-repute, we lived days of days at Kul-kīna!"

A large pool of a perimeter of around 2 miles lied to the east of Shāh-of-Kabūl and south of the walled-town. Three small springs, Kul-kīna; near Khwāja Shamū's tomb; second one near Khwāja Khiẓr's Qadam-gāh, and the third was at a place known as Khwāja Raushānāī, over against Khwāja 'Abdu'ṣ-ṣamad.

The citadel of Kābul stood on 'Uqābain, a detached rock of a spur of Shāh-of-Kābul with great walled-town lying at its north end. At the high altitude where citadel lied, fresh air blew at high speed. It overlooked the large pool (mentioned above) and three meadows, namely, Siyāh-sang (Black-rock), Sūng-qūrghān (Fort-back), and Chālāk (Highwayman). It appeared very heavenly when the meadows were green. In the months of summer, the gushing north winds, known by locals as Parwān-wind helped in making thermal comfort delightful in the windowed houses which lied on the northern part of the citadel. Praising the citadel of Kābul, Mullā Muḥammad ṭālib Mu'ammāī (the Riddler) often recited a couplet, composed on Badī'u'z-zamān Mīrzā's name:—

Drink wine in the castle of Kābul and send the cup round without pause;
For Kābul is mountain, is river, is city, is lowland in one.

b. Kābul as a trading-town.

Babur mentions in the *Baburnama* that, 'Just as 'Arabs call every place outside 'Arab (Arabia), 'Ajam, so Hindustanīs call every place outside Hindustan, Khurāsān.'

On the land-route between Hindustan and Khurāsān there were two trade-marts. Kābul was one of them and Qandahār was other. While the caravans to Kābul came from Kāshghar, Ferghana, Turkistān, Samarkand, Bukhārā, Balkh, Ḥiṣār and Badakhshān, those to Qandahār came only from Khurāsān. Kābul was known as an excellent trading center as it was well known facts among merchants that if they went to Khīta or Rūm, they would make very small profits. Each year around 10,000 horses and caravans of 10–20,000 heads-of-houses came to Kābul for trade. They would bring slaves, white cloth, sugar-candy, refined and common sugars, and aromatic roots.

Babur mentions in the *Baburnama* that most of the traders were not content with a profit of around 20–30 per cent.